

FEBRUARY 1-15, 1980

ministry after the Delhi bomb blasts, then the Mumbai terror attacks could have been averted ("The New Super Cop", November 30). Chidambaram deserves applause for his single-minded resolve and action to secure the country, working closely with chief ministers who otherwise have ego issues while dealing with the Union Home Minister.

BIKASH CHOUDHURY,
Bhubaneswar

Road Blocked

Although India enjoys the dubious distinction of the highest number of road fatalities, yet the issue of road safety surprisingly does not figure in the much-touted agendas of any of the political parties ("Killer Roads", November 23). Probably in the perception of these parties, the matter of road safety is of little relevance and merits attention only at the municipal or local levels. Even booming towns like Gurgaon, otherwise dotted with swanky skyscrapers, glitzy malls, hotels, the IT sector and green buildings, have no decent public transport.

L.K. CHAWLA, *Gurgaon*

House Etiquette

It is not only the responsibility of the Speaker and the Chairperson to notice the violation of rules and contravention in the Houses ("Business of the

Day", November 23) but even the leaders of political parties should examine questions asked by members. If such questions are found objectionable, they should reproach the members to avoid conflict of interest.

INDU SHANKAR, *Varanasi*

Failing State

M.A. Jinnah got Pakistan in 1947 and Pakistan got civil war in 1970-71 when the duly elected leader of

otherwise it shall be difficult to conquer this irregular army which the Government of Pakistan raised for India but is now itself facing. A peaceful Pakistan is the best bet for India.

AMRIT LAL RAWAL, *Delhi*

Speaking his Mind

It is clear that Kapil Sibal sees himself as a reformer who can leave a mark on the ministry ("Mr Loud-speaker", November 16).

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“The political crisis for the BJP in Karnataka, with the rich Reddy brothers of Bellary holding the BJP Government to ransom, has exposed the steep fall in our democratic values.”

SUBHASH CHANDRA AGRAWAL, *Delhi*

the Awami League was not allowed to become the prime minister of Pakistan ("Can Pakistan be Saved?", November 16). The hapless country has been living with civil war ever since. The conditions in Pakistan today are nothing short of a civil war. The Pakistan Government should overcome the enemy within

Not only does he intend to make India a hub of world education, but has also come out with new governance rules, thinking beyond the IITs and the CBSE. He aims at making Indian education more democratic than ever before.

P.K. GUPTA,
Bhatinda

Commissions to Stay

Commissions of enquiry might have been just as responsible as onion prices in bringing Mrs Gandhi back to South Block. But that hardly put off the Marxists of West Bengal, who decided last fortnight to go ahead with all four of the state's commissions of enquiry into misdeeds allegedly committed by the earlier Congress regime. Soon after the results of parliamentary elections were known, a few non-CPI (M) cabinet members of the state began speculating on the use of keeping the commissions alive as it was felt that no witness would venture now to give evidence against the ruling party at the Centre. But Marxist leaders, including Jyoti Basu, called up officials to hasten action against persons held guilty by the commissions. Said Hasim Abdul Halim, the state's justice minister: "The people of West Bengal voted us to power after we told them that we'd hold judicial inquiry into certain incidents. The verdict of 1980 does not seem to reverse the mandate."

by Sumit Mitra



**JYOTI
 BASU**

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